



# MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



## SACRED TEXT

*kiṃ vā dākṣiṇya+mātreṇa | bhāvena\*astu parigrahaḥ |  
viṣayān dur+labhāṃl\* labdhvā | na hy\* avajñātum arhasi | |4.71|  
kāmaṃ\* param iti jñātvā | devo\* \*api hi puraṃ+daraḥ |  
gautamasya muneḥ patnīm | ahalyāṃ\* cakame purā | |4.72|  
agastyah prārthayām āsa | soma+bhāryāṃ\* ca rohiṇīm |  
tasmāt tat+sa+(dṛśīm\* Cdṛsaṃ\*)lebhe | lopā+mudrām iti śrutih | |4.73|*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 4, Verse 1

## GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Within these verses from the Buddhacarita, we encounter a powerful argument centered on desire and its perceived inevitability. The speaker, attempting to dissuade Siddhartha from renunciation, suggests that even the gods are not immune to the pull of worldly pleasures. The argument hinges on the idea that having attained such rare and delightful experiences, Siddhartha should not dismiss them. The speaker cites examples from Hindu mythology, such as Indra's desire for Ahalya, Gautama's wife, and Agastya's longing for Rohini, Soma's wife, to illustrate that even divine beings succumb to the allure of sensual gratification.

The underlying message is a challenge to Siddhartha's resolve, questioning whether his detachment is truly possible or even desirable, given the precedent set by powerful figures in their shared cultural history. These figures, despite their divine status or wisdom, actively pursued worldly pleasures. The speaker implies that Siddhartha's renunciation would be an act of unprecedented self-denial, perhaps even a rejection of the natural order.

However, looking beyond the literal interpretation, we can view these verses as a reflection on the nature of temptation and the human tendency to justify our desires. The speaker uses the actions of mythological figures to normalize the pursuit of pleasure, suggesting that if even gods are not free from desire, then mortals like Siddhartha should not be expected to abstain.

For you in modern life, this passage invites reflection on the narratives we use to rationalize our choices. How often do you justify your actions by pointing to the behavior of others, particularly those in positions of power or influence? This passage urges you to examine the stories you tell yourself about what is acceptable or inevitable, and to consider whether these narratives are truly aligned with your values and aspirations. It challenges you to question the assumptions that underpin your decisions, and to cultivate a deeper awareness of the influences that shape your desires. Ultimately, the passage encourages you to forge your own path, rather than blindly following the precedents set by others.

## REFLECTION FOR TODAY

*Are you using the actions of others to justify your own choices, and are these justifications truly serving your highest self?*